

AIWA Meteor MI-X330

Quality without bells and whistles

The Bluetooth speakers market has been growing exponentially in recent years. One brand that has taken a plunge into the sea of Bluetooth speakers is AIWA. The Japanese brand, known for its TVs in the yesteryears, has now stepped into the world of Bluetooth speakers. When AIWA's latest MI-X 330 Meteor showed up at the Digit Test Centre, we were excited. Without giving many spoilers, we'll say that our enthusiasm was served well, and the speaker did not let us down. Here's a detailed look into our time spent testing the AIWA MI-X 330 Meteor speaker –

BUILD AND DESIGN

The build and design of the speaker is where you get the first sense of why the company priced the speaker so exorbitantly. The speaker has a metallic body and an exquisite detachable leather strap, which can be used to ferry around this 3 kg speaker.

On the speaker, you get buttons to control the input mode and basic play pause, power, and track change controls. There is a small circular display on the front of the speaker that displays information about the volume level, the battery of the device, and the connectivity.

On the back of the speaker, you will find a neat selection of ports. You get a micro-SD card slot and a USB Type-A port that allow you to play tracks directly off your storage device. You also get an AUX port as well as a 3.5mm jack for connecting microphones to the device. And rounding this strong I/O panel is a USB Type-C port that can be used to charge the speaker.

FEATURES

With the AIWA MI-X 330 Meteor, you get a set of features that are adequate for the job. It does not come packed with all the bells and whistles like some other speakers in the market. The features are limited, yet useful. One that stands out is the TWS Multi-Link. This feature allows you to daisy chain multiple



devices together. Apart from this, looking objectively, the AIWA MI-X330 is a pretty barebones speaker with no bells and whistles that you'd get with some other speakers in the market. You do not get support for voice assistants or the ability to take calls on the speaker.

What you do get is an unmatched audio-listening experience, which is what most people shelling out so much money on the speaker would want. But there is a sub-section of consumers who will want some additional features in a Bluetooth speaker, which they are spending a chunk of their money on. This is where the AIWA will fall to the back of the pack.

PERFORMANCE

The tweeter and sub-woofer combo produces a sound that can be best described as - aural bliss. The speaker is not the loudest you will find out there, and it was trumped by some other speakers that showed up at the Digit Test Centre along with it. However, the sound that is produced, even at the maximum volume levels by this speaker, is something that would put most competitors to shame.

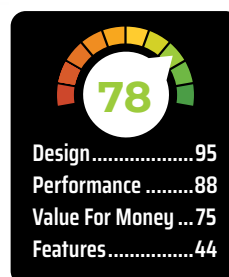
In songs like Centuries and Hotel California, the AIWA MI-X330 Meteor held its ground with grandeur. And, when playing tracks like Uptown Funk, we got just the right amount of bass response from the speaker, which added to the audio listening experience. Additionally, the ability to tune the bass using the dial

on the speaker gave us some more flexibility. The vocals of the artists in songs like Rescue Me were clear, and we were not left out in the wild fishing for lines we love the most!

The overall output pleasantly surprised us by being very close to neutral for the most part. Yes, the soundstage of the speaker is not as broad as some of the truly 360-degree speakers out there. But the sound output from the speaker is clear and loud enough to fill a large room with ease.

In our testing, the speaker got fairly loud without showing distortion in its sound, and the latency when playing files using the Bluetooth connection as well was minimal. Powering this setup was

a 5000mAh battery, which, as claimed by the brand, is supposed to last anywhere between 6 to 10 hours. When we put those claims to the test, we found that the speaker, at 50 per cent volume, and the bass set at the mid-way mark, lasted about 7 hours, which is well within the claimed range.



VERDICT

The AIWA MI-X330 is a speaker that we can promise will put a smile on your face when you listen to it for the first time. If you are someone who loves that flat sound signature or someone who likes to have some bass thrown into the mix as well, you will enjoy owning the speaker. Everything from the build quality to the sound signature screams quality!

However, if you are looking for a feature-packed speaker, then this is not the one. We'd recommend you look at the Sonos Roam or the LG RP4G XBoom 360. They bring many more features to the table, with the Sonos being priced lower than AIWA's offering.

—Satvik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

Frequency Response: 70 Hz-20KHz | Signal to Noise Ratio: > 70dB+3dB | Power Output: 60W | Playback Time: 6-10 Hours | Charging Time: Around 6-10 Hours | Battery: Built-in Lithium Ion 7.2V/ 5000mAh | BT Version: BT5.0

CONTACT

Phone: NA | Email: Web form | Website: www.aiwaindia.com/